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Exercise 15

Directions: ***Preview the passage. Then read it and underline the facts. Working with another student, answer the questions that follow.***

A New Pesticide in India

In two states in India, Andhra Pradesh and Chattisgarh, farmers have discovered a new kind of pesticide.[1] Instead of paying large sums of money to international chemical companies for chemical pesticides, they are spraying their cotton and chili pepper fields with Coca-Cola.

In the past month there have been reports of hundreds of farmers spraying cola on their fields. Thousands of others are expected to make the switch[2] to cola from the usual pesticides as word spreads about the new spray. A farmer in Andhra Pradesh interviewed by a local newspaper said he was very satisfied with his new cola spray, which he applied this year to several acres of cotton. He observed that the insects on his cotton plants began to die soon after he sprayed his fields with cola.

Local agriculture officials would not comment on this new development, except to note that the cola spray cost considerably less than the pesticides produced by Montsanto, Shell and Dow Chemical. The Coca-Cola Company already is in legal difficulties in Andhra Pradesh state, where it has been accused of taking water away from farmers for its bottling plants. So far, representatives of the Coca-Cola Company have refused to comment on the new use of their product. It is not known if or how sales of the soft drinks have been affected, though it is likely that the company may try to profit from this new market.

(Source: Adapted from "Things grow better with Coke." *The Guardian Weekly*, November 5-11, 2004)

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[1] *pesticide: a* chemical used to kill insects that destroy plants
[2] *switch:* the replacement of an object with a similar object

1. What facts are included in the first paragraph?

The facts included in the first paragraph are:

- Farmers in Andhra Pradesh and Chhattisgarh are using Coca-Cola as a pesticide alternative.
- They are opting for Coca-Cola instead of expensive chemical pesticides.
- The Coca-Cola spray is reported to be effective against insects on cotton and chili pepper fields.

2. What can you infer about the cost of pesticides in India?

From the information above , it can be inferred that the cost of traditional pesticides produced by companies like Montsanto, Shell, and Dow Chemical is considerably high, prompting farmers to seek cheaper alternatives like Coca-Cola.

3. What facts are included in the second paragraph?

The second paragraph states:
- Local agriculture officials have not commented on this new use of Coca-Cola.
- Coca-Cola Company representatives have refused to comment on the matter.
- There are legal issues involving Coca-Cola in Andhra Pradesh related to water usage for bottling plants.

4. What can you infer about cola spray?

From the text, it can be inferred that cola spray is gaining popularity among farmers as an alternative to traditional pesticides due to its effectiveness and lower cost compared to chemical pesticides.

5. What facts are included in the third paragraph?

In the third paragraph, it is mentioned that:
- Hundreds of farmers have already started using cola spray on their fields.
- Thousands of others are expected to follow suit.
- A farmer in Andhra Pradesh expressed satisfaction with the results of using cola spray on his cotton fields.

6. What can you infer about the economic situation of the farmers in Andhra Pradesh?

From the given information, it can be inferred that the economic situation of farmers in Andhra Pradesh is challenging, as they are seeking cost-effective alternatives to traditional pesticides to manage their crops effectively and reduce expenses.

7. What can you infer about the Coca-Cola Company in India?

Regarding the Coca-Cola Company in India, it can be inferred that:
- The company is facing legal issues related to its operations in Andhra Pradesh.
- Despite being implicated in controversies, the company has not commented on the new use of its product as a pesticide.
- It is likely that the company may attempt to capitalize on this new market opportunity, although no specific actions have been mentioned.